

Narayan Ashanahalli



Designer

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Interaction designer focused on spatial interactions — building systems that understand physical context and respond to the humans within it. Grounded in strong design and systems thinking, I work through building and prototyping tangible interfaces. Looking to join a lean, technical team building the next generation of foundational tools.

WORK EXPERIENCE

Lab for Cybernetics

Aug 2024 — current

Design Researcher

- Led the design and development of the Lab's foundational digital infrastructure — a full-stack platform with a Notion-based CMS built for long-term maintainability.
- Shipped an AI-powered matchmaking feature based on research interests and expertise within the platform with 25+ active practitioners and scholars.
- Built a spatial graph archive for the Cybernetics of Cybernetics book — mapping 200+ systems literature nodes into an interactive spatial structure making dense conceptual relationships navigable.

Studio Chintala

Aug 2023 — July 2024

Project Designer

- Led design strategy for Amara Raja's 7.5M sqft manufacturing campus: ran on-site employee research and developed spatial analysis methodology for first-time rural workforce needs.
- Analyzed industrial urbanism trends and existing conditions across five spatial systems: circulation, green infrastructure, way-finding, workplace zones, and utilities.
- Proposed 4-phase implementation plan with cost-tiered solutions balancing operational constraints, starting with a \$10,000 Phase 1 pilot.
- Produced environmental graphics for Shell Corporation: executed 8'x8' interactive way-finding installation and 400+ sqft of laser-cut acrylic branding across 6 employee break-rooms, serving 200+ daily users.
- Initial design and drawings for a 60,000 SQFT office interior renovation
- Managed the design, production, and manufacturing of product development for the firm's product line, Be.Liv.

Nelson Worldwide

Dec 2023 — July 2024

Visual Designer

- Contributed to revamped presentation system and stakeholder portfolio templates for business development across multiple industry verticals. (Nelson Worldwide, sister firm to Studio Chintala)

M9 Design Studio

Aug 2022 — Jan 2023

Architecture Intern

- Collaborated on the design and execution of environmental graphics and art installations for an award-winning memorial project,
- Contributions of visual narrative featured in the "Emergent Practices in South Asia" publication by Harvard GSD.

Uniworks Design

Aug 2020 — Jan 2021

Machine Learning Intern

- Contributed to ArP-Gen, a machine learning project automating architectural floor plan generation

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EDUCATION

Carnegie Mellon University

2024 — Present

Masters in Advanced Architecture Design

Jawaharlal Nehru Architecture & Fine Arts University

2018 — 2023

Bachelor in Architecture

PROJECT EXPERIENCE

Product Designer | Dot Threads

- Designed and shipped browser extension exploring spatial approaches to knowledge management, currently live on Chrome Web Store with +10 active users.
- Shipped 4 click workflow and graph-based canvas for organizing web links by context and relationships.

Interaction Designer | Pointobot

- Designed a camera-based task assistance system that reads physical workspace and user state, reasons about task progress, and delivers structured guidance (correct, clarify, or redirect).
- Developed an interaction framework mapping three input signals (object state, user actions, task state) to three intervention modes for physical assembly tasks.

Interaction Designer | Piko

- Designed a soft robotic companion detecting doom-scrolling posture with 91% accuracy using a custom-trained computer vision model, delivering peripheral physical feedback as a habit-building nudge.
- Developed an emotive gesture library translating four behavioral states into physical servo movements — curiosity, joy, shyness, anger — creating social feedback without language.
- Trained a custom CV model on 400+ images using Roboflow, distributed across a three-node Raspberry Pi architecture for low-latency accurate real-time response.

SKILLS

Design

UX Research
Product Strategy
Interaction Design
Information Architecture
Prototyping
Visual Design
Systems Thinking
Data Visualization
Survey Design

Tools

Figma
Illustrator
InDesign
Photoshop
Premiere Pro
Framer
Sketch
Rhino 3D
HTML
CSS
JavaScript
Python
GitHub
Grasshopper